



network and potential attackers. Criminals may also try to gain access to data through human vulnerability. To avoid this, train staff to recognize potential attacks, such as phishing, where emails are used to trick the receiver into giving away passwords and user names, or malware programs, which install on a computer when you click on a link or email.

Seek free data protection advice from business organizations and government agencies. Also, be sure to meet any cybersecurity regulations.

63%

of data breaches involve stolen, default, or weak passwords

Verizon, Data Breach Investigations Report, enterprise.verizon.com, 2016



NEED TO KNOW

- › **Malware** is short for malicious software—any program that damages a computer's operating system and the data it contains.
- › **Ransomware** is malware that infects a computer and demands a ransom to be paid electronically in return for restoring the computer to normal.
- › **Denial of service** is a cyber attack that floods computer or web systems with bogus requests that stop users from connecting, allowing criminals to gain access.



Test and update computer security

Cyber attackers continually find new ways to steal data, so you need to be constantly on your guard.

- › **Use vulnerability scan programs** to identify any weak points in your computer system, whether outside the network or inside—once a “trusted user” has signed in
- › **Make sure the latest security software** is installed on your computers
- › **Check that all default passwords** on new devices and software have been reset

Keep staff alert

Take the lead and inform staff of the dangers of cyber attack and how it can impact the business.

- › **Teach staff**, particularly those in closest contact with sensitive data, how to spot and report attacks
- › **Encourage safe browsing** so that staff recognize suspect emails, text messages, apps, and web links

